

## **Edinburgh Dysphagia Score**

*The Edinburgh Dysphagia Score (EDS) was developed with the aim of creating a simple yet highly sensitive scoring system that would allow patients to be categorised into low and high risk groups for an underlying malignant diagnosis based on key information present at referral. In the original study the EDS had a negative predictive value of 99.3% and a sensitivity of 97.5%.*

*The usefulness therefore of EDS rests with the high negative predictive value; in the published study, only one patient with  $EDS < 3.5$  had malignancy as the cause of their dysphagia.*

*It was estimated that approximately 30-35% of dysphagia referrals from primary care had a score of  $< 3.5$  and would not require endoscopy through the urgent suspicion of cancer (USOC) / 2 week wait (2WW) pathway, although a lower priority endoscopy would still be required.*

*An  $EDS \geq 3.5$  identified the group of patients at high risk for cancer and in that group the cancer yield at endoscopy was approximately 17-20%.*

*The Edinburgh Dysphagia Score can therefore be used to identify patients at lower risk of a malignant diagnosis and allow resources to be concentrated on those at highest risk.*

## Edinburgh Dysphagia Score

| <b>A</b> |        |
|----------|--------|
| Age      | Points |
| 18-39    | 0      |
| 40-49    | 4      |
| 50-59    | 5      |
| 60-69    | 6      |
| 70-79    | 7      |
| 80-89    | 8      |
| 90-99    | 9      |

| <b>B</b> |    |
|----------|----|
| Gender   |    |
| Male     | 0  |
| Female   | -1 |

| <b>C</b>            |    |
|---------------------|----|
| Current acid reflux |    |
| Yes                 | -1 |
| No                  | 0  |

| <b>D</b>                    |    |
|-----------------------------|----|
| Dysphagia localises to neck |    |
| Yes                         | -2 |
| No                          | 0  |

| <b>E</b>         |   |
|------------------|---|
| Weight loss >3Kg |   |
| Yes              | 2 |
| No               | 0 |

| <b>F</b>                 |      |
|--------------------------|------|
| Duration of symptoms >6m |      |
| Yes                      | -1.5 |
| No                       | 0    |

A+B+C+D+E+F = Edinburgh Dysphagia Score

If **≥3.5** then patient requires further investigation as higher risk of cancer

If **<3.5** then lower risk